

Skills Summary

Rounding to Named Places

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Rounding on a Number Line

Model: draw the two nearest “round” numbers at the ends, mark the **midpoint**, and place your number. Whichever end it is closer to is the rounded value. (Exactly at the midpoint: round up.)

Example: Round 276 to the nearest hundred.

Step 1. 276 sits between 200 and 300, so mark the midpoint 250 and see which side 276 is on.

Step 2. $276 > 250$, so 276 is closer to 300. $\Rightarrow$ **300**

Try it: Use a number line to round 43 to the nearest ten.

check: 40

Skill 2 — The Digit Rule

Rule: underline the digit in the named place, then look **one place to the right**: 0–4 keeps the underlined digit, 5–9 rounds it up. Everything to the right of the named place becomes zero.

Example: Round 8,624 to the nearest thousand.

Step 1. Underline the thousands digit 8, then check the digit to its right: the hundreds digit is 6.

Step 2. $6 \geq 5$, so the 8 rounds up to 9 and the rest zero out: $8,624 \rightarrow 9,000 \Rightarrow$ **9,000**

Try it: Round 8,624 to the nearest *hundred*.

check: 8,600

Skill 3 — Rounding in Real Contexts

When rounding shows up in life: reported attendance, poster totals, news headlines. The context names the place (“to the nearest thousand”) — find that place, apply the digit rule, and keep the units in your answer.

Example: A city counts 31,865 bus riders. A report gives the count to the nearest thousand. What number is reported?

Step 1. The named place is thousands: underline the 1; the digit to its right is 8.

Step 2. $8 \geq 5$, so 31 thousands become 32 thousands: $31,865 \rightarrow 32,000$ riders $\Rightarrow$ **32,000**

Try it: A school raises 4,712 dollars. What is the total to the nearest hundred dollars?

check: 4,700

(!) Watch out: rounding can carry. Rounding 3,997 to the nearest ten gives 4,000 — the 99 tens become 100 tens, and the carry changes three digits at once. Never round just the underlined digit by itself.